CLASS 8 — SOCIAL_SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why did Delhi sultans often rule for short periods? 1

(a) Rule was by election
(b) Power was often seized by eliminating the earlier ruler
(c) Kings were children
(d) The Sultanate was tiny

2. Why was the navy valuable to Shivaji? 1

(a) It replaced forts **(b)** It secured the coast and sea trade
(c) It made him the Mughal emperor **(d)** It ended taxes

3. Why did Europeans seek new sea routes to India? 1

(a) They disliked trade
(b) They wanted to teach Indians
(c) They had no ships
(d) Land routes were controlled by others and trade was profitable

4. Razmnama translations were meant to 1

(a) end Sanskrit
(b) replace Persian
(c) burn old books
(d) make Indian texts accessible to the court

5. Aurangzeb's capture of Raigad and execution of Sambhaji 1

(a) united the Mughals **(b)** failed to destroy Maratha resistance
(c) made peace **(d)** ended the Marathas

6. The drain of wealth theory claims that 1

(a) India became rich
(b) taxes were low
(c) Britain invested all
(d) India's resources flowed to Britain without return

7. Hundis were important because they 1

(a) were forts **(b)** taxed traders
(c) enabled safe transfer of money **(d)** were royal orders

8. A shiledar differs from a bargir in that he 1

(a) was a minister **(b)** was a priest
(c) supplied his own horse and equipment **(d)** was given equipment by the state

9. Indigo planters were resented because 1

(a) ended tax
(b) paid high prices
(c) they forced peasants to grow indigo at low prices
(d) built schools

10. Ala-ud-din Khilji's title 'Sikander Sani' reflects his 1

(a) religious tolerance **(b)** ambition to be a world conqueror
(c) love of poetry **(d)** peaceful nature

11. Shivaji's use of guerrilla war suited the Deccan because 1

(a) there were no forests **(b)** cavalry was banned
(c) hills and forts helped quick raids **(d)** plains favoured elephants

12. The cartaz system shows that the Portuguese 1

(a) tried to control Arabian Sea trade **(b)** avoided Asia
(c) had no navy **(d)** encouraged free trade

13. A mansabdar had to maintain troops, which 1

(a) ended taxes **(b)** cancelled ranks
(c) weakened it **(d)** strengthened the Mughal army

14. The Peshwas' control over Chhatrapatis shows 1

(a) end of the Peshwa
(b) rule by the British
(c) rise of the Mughals
(d) shift of real power to the prime minister

15. Cheap British cloth ruined Indian weavers because 1

(a) Indian cloth was heavily taxed in Britain
(b) there was no demand
(c) weavers disliked work
(d) it was costlier to make

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why was the Delhi Sultanate unstable? 2

17. Why did Shivaji abolish hereditary posts? 2

18. Why did Europeans want direct trade with India? 2

19. How was the mansabdari system useful to Mughals? 2

20. Why did bhakti saints matter to Maratha unity? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain why Muhammad bin Tughlaq's experiments failed. 3

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22. How did bhakti saints lay a base for Maratha identity? 3

23. Explain how the Portuguese tried to control the Arabian Sea. 3

24. Explain how the Sikh Gurus responded to persecution. 3

OR

Explain how Shivaji ensured honest administration. 3

25. Explain the effect of tariffs on Indian crafts. 3

OR

How did Krishnadevaraya promote culture? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Analyse how the five dynasties of the Sultanate tried to build a lasting state. 5

OR

Explain how geography, forts and tactics shaped the rise of Shivaji. 5

27. Explain why Europeans came to India and why only the British succeeded. 5

OR

Explain how new technology and tactics changed warfare in medieval India. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

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